

Specialist Behaviour Support Policy and Procedures

VERSION 1.0	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER Principal / Key Management Personnel	APPROVED BY Governing body
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PURPOSE AT A GLANCE

This policy explains how [] delivers specialist behaviour support (Module 2) — assessing behaviours of concern, developing evidence-informed positive behaviour support plans that work towards reducing and eliminating restrictive practices, ensuring practitioners are suitable and clinically supervised, and lodging and reporting as required by the NDIS Commission.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy supports [] to apply the Specialist Behaviour Support NDIS Practice Standard. It applies to all services and supports delivered by [] and to all employees, contractors and volunteers (**Workers**), who must take full responsibility for understanding and following it. It should be read alongside the related documents in the final section and the corresponding procedures in the Policy Register.

2. Policy aims

[] is committed to ensuring that:

- each participant accesses behaviour support appropriate to their needs that incorporates evidence-informed practice and complies with relevant legislation and policy frameworks;
- each participant is only subject to a restrictive practice that meets State or Territory authorisation requirements and the safeguards in Commonwealth legislation and policy;
- each participant's quality of life is maintained and improved by a tailored, current behaviour support plan that is implemented effectively and progresses towards the reduction and elimination of restrictive practices;
- any emergency or unauthorised use of a restrictive practice is reported and reviewed; and
- each participant with an immediate need receives an interim behaviour support plan that minimises risk to the participant and others.

3. Practitioners and supervision

[] only engages behaviour support practitioners the NDIS Commission has assessed as suitable under the Positive Behaviour Support Capability Framework. Each practitioner undertakes ongoing professional development to stay current with evidence-informed practice, and a specialist behaviour support clinical supervisor provides clinical supervision of each practitioner's work. [] demonstrates a commitment to reducing and eliminating restrictive practices through its policies, procedures and practices.

4. Assessment and plan development

The practitioner conducts a functional behaviour assessment to understand the purpose of the behaviours of concern, using interviews, observation and data (for example ABC data). A participant with an immediate need receives an **interim behaviour support plan** — developed within one month where there is risk — and a **comprehensive behaviour support plan** follows, based on the assessment. Plans are person-centred, involve the participant and their support network (including any advocate or decision-making support), set out proactive strategies to improve quality of life and teach skills, and include a plan to reduce and eliminate any restrictive practices.

5. Authorisation, lodgement and reporting

Where a plan contains a regulated restrictive practice, [] supports the implementing provider to obtain State or Territory authorisation where required, includes the authorisation details in the plan's schedule of restrictive practices, and lodges the plan (and any reviewed plan) with the NDIS Commissioner as soon as practicable, in the manner required — regardless of whether State or Territory authorisation is required or obtained. Plans lodged are recorded in the Restrictive Practices Register. Any emergency or unauthorised use of a restrictive practice is reported to the NDIS Commission and reviewed.

6. Implementation, training and review

[] provides the implementing provider(s) with the plan and supporting tools and trains their staff and carers, with the participant, to implement it (recorded on the Coaching Form for PBSP). Implementing providers are asked to collect ongoing data (ABC Data Forms), which the practitioner analyses regularly, providing a written summary at least every three months. Each plan is reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner if required, together with a review of all incidents in the previous 12 months, with particular focus on reducing and eliminating restrictive practices.

7. Definitions

[]

[], ABN [].

Client

A client of [], including an NDIS participant.

Key Management Personnel (KMP)

[], and other key management personnel involved in [] from time to time.

Principal

[].

Legislation Register

The register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by [].

Policy Register

The register of policies of [].

Worker

A permanent, fixed-term or casual member of staff, a contractor or a volunteer engaged by [], including the Principal.

Regulated restrictive practice

A restrictive practice of a kind described in the NDIS (Restrictive Practices and Behaviour Support) Rules 2018 — seclusion, chemical, mechanical, physical or environmental restraint.

NDIS behaviour support practitioner

A person the NDIS Commission has assessed as suitable to deliver specialised positive behaviour support, including assessments and the development of behaviour support plans.

8. Related documents and approval

Related documents: Behaviour Support Plan - Interim · Behaviour Support Plan - Comprehensive · ABC Data Form · Coaching Form for PBSP · Restrictive Practices Register · Statement of Support for the reduction and elimination of the use of restrictive practices · Letter to implementing providers · Behaviour Support Practitioner Position Description · Incident Management and Reporting Policy · Legislation Register · Policy Register.

Legislation and rules: as set out in the Legislation Register. If any part of this policy is inconsistent with applicable law, it is taken to be amended only to the extent needed to comply.

Approved by	
Approval date	
Next scheduled review	
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